

the traditional resume format does not do any justice when documenting that path. Suppose you come across a slightly off resume, which does not look like a traditional one; probe further. You may be dealing with a cross-functionally experienced person. Although their career path looks non-linear and does not make sense at first glance, talking to them can often give you a better perspective. In most cases, they can draw a connecting line between all those experiences. And that can help you make the decision.

12. They are good at problem-solving but better at problem finding

Yes, problem-solving is a commonly revered skill for all cadre of employees. And when you deal with well-defined problems, that's all you need from someone. However, finding better problems to solve is becoming a forgotten skill. When you have someone who can find better problems to solve, it can open up a new potential opportunity for your business. It may help you tap into a completely new market, which can be a serious advantage for your business.

Testing a candidate for problem-finding ability is relatively easier. Of course, you want a meaningful problem finder who is willing to solve the problem too, not a complainer who finds faults but does nothing to fix them.

13. Avoid specialists; prefer more synthesists

If you ask someone, "What is the opposite of a specialist?" You will most likely hear, "A generalist." And that is incorrect. The real opposite of a specialist is synthesist. Specialists are good at breaking down things and working on them at a deeper level. On the other hand, synthesists are good at combining things and looking at the big picture.

The success of meaningful innovation is in defining its higher-level context in which your innovative product or solution will eventually operate. Only synthesists can see the big picture and explain how a particular innovation fits a bigger system or situation. It also means that synthesists can often connect the dots and derive innovation from different fields. More often than not, innovation is less about original ideas and more about original combinations.

14. They know what they don't know

'Know it all' people do not make a good fit for innovation teams. This point is a corollary to being more curious and less judgmental. When people are self-aware, they know their limits, and they also know what to seek. Knowing what you do not know pushes you to learn that skill or find that information. It develops an attitude of continuous learning.

15. They challenge the status quo with logic

As I mentioned before, innovation requires the ability and willingness to challenge the status quo. However, there is a major difference between being a rebel for its sake and being pragmatic with logic. It can be slightly tricky to test it out when you are in the hiring process, mainly because everyone wants to show their best-case persona in the hiring process. These nuances are easy to miss.

16. They are modest about achievements

This one is a bit odd. In any hiring process, both parties want to highlight their achievements and boost their advantage as much as possible. However, this is when you are most likely to miss better candidates for your innovation journey because these candidates are modest about their achievements.

I have seen in many cases people jump the gun and celebrate their innovation win too early. In other cases, the proportion of their celebration does not even match the outcome. It can be detrimental to your innovation programme in the long run.

Candidate's modest nature often puts them behind the queue. So, next time you find a candidate being modest about their achievements, chances are they are a good fit for the innovation role.

17. They are experimenters and action takers

As a corollary to point 4 and 6 above, innovative people are avid experimenters and have a strong bias towards taking action. You will find them constantly experimenting and testing out various assumptions. And when they see a positive outcome or find a way through that experimentation, they take action.

It often needs tenacity, perseverance, and patience. Many see patience as a roadblock in a world where everything is moving fast or appears to be moving fast. But not the innovators.

So, in your hiring process, see how you can check these qualities. Particularly, see how you can make them show the experimenter in them. It will be interesting as well as supportive of the process of selection.

18. Look for diversity of thinking, experience, and skills

When we talk about diversity, we usually think of gender balance or demographics. However, for innovation, we also need diversity of thinking, experience, and skills.

Diversity of thinking comes from the fact that you have learned to think differently. You do not just follow what others are saying. Your opinions are based on what you see around you, and you can